

August 12, 2026

BlueChoice HealthPlan of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Unit
P.O. Box 6170
Columbia, SC 29260

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Vanda Franecki (MRN MUSC0570669), Claim MUSC-20260523-1AC8-1

Patient	Vanda Franecki (DOB 1948-04-26)
MRN	MUSC0570669
Member ID / Group	BLU259860418 / GRP-81943
Claim number	MUSC-20260523-1AC8-1
Date of service	2026-05-23
Procedure billed	CPT 94060 — Bronchodilator responsiveness, spirometry
Primary diagnosis	R69 — Illness, unspecified
Denied amount	\$534.30
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-10-13

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this first-level reconsideration on behalf of patient Vanda Franecki (Member ID: BLU259860418, Group: GRP-81943) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20260523-1AC8-1, covering services rendered on May 23, 2026, at MUSC Health University Medical Center. The claim was denied on July 15, 2026, under CARC 16 and RARC N290, with the payer remark stating: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid," citing a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and requests full adjudication and payment of the claim at the allowed amount of \$336.51 for CPT 94060.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Franecki is a 78-year-old female with an established history of pulmonary emphysema, type 2 diabetes mellitus with associated neuropathy and retinopathy, obesity, and metabolic syndrome, all of which are active conditions documented in her medical record. She has a documented history of serial spirometry testing and ongoing pulmonary rehabilitation dating to at least 2011, consistent with longitudinal management of her obstructive lung disease. On May 23, 2026, she presented as an outpatient at MUSC Health University Medical Center, where Dr. Daniel R. Okafor, MD, performed bronchodilator responsiveness spirometry (CPT 94060) to assess her pulmonary function. This service was rendered in an on-campus outpatient hospital setting (Place of Service 22) and submitted to BlueChoice HealthPlan of South Carolina on June 3, 2026, with a billed charge of \$534.30.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is RARC N290, indicating that the rendering provider's primary identifier was missing, incomplete, or invalid on the submitted claim. MUSC Health has reviewed the original claim submission and confirms that the National Provider Identifier (NPI) for the rendering provider, Dr. Daniel R. Okafor, MD, is 1558493021. This NPI is valid, active, and properly associated with Dr. Okafor in the NPPES registry. To the extent that this information was not received or recognized by BlueChoice HealthPlan during initial adjudication, MUSC Health is resubmitting the rendering provider NPI with this appeal for the plan's review and correction.

A denial based solely on an administrative data element discrepancy — particularly one that is correctable and does not implicate the medical necessity or appropriateness of the service — does not constitute a valid basis for withholding payment when the underlying service was covered, medically appropriate, and rendered by a credentialed provider. CPT 94060 was performed by a licensed physician at a covered facility during an active coverage period (January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026), and the claim was submitted within a timely filing window. BlueChoice HealthPlan's own appeal and reconsideration rights obligations, as well as generally accepted prompt-pay standards applicable to commercial insurers in South Carolina, support correction and payment of clean claims where the only deficiency is a curable administrative element.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that BlueChoice HealthPlan of South Carolina accept the rendering provider NPI of 1558493021 for Dr. Daniel R. Okafor, MD, as submitted herein, reprocess Claim MUSC-20260523-1AC8-1 in full, and issue payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$336.51 for CPT 94060 rendered on May 23, 2026. Should additional documentation be required to complete adjudication, please contact the MUSC Health Revenue Cycle Appeals team directly. This reconsideration is filed electronically via MIM in accordance with BlueChoice HealthPlan's stated appeal process, within the appeal deadline of October 13, 2026.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC
Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management

MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record